

matcami Inventory

Business brief · what the inventory feature does, how stock and cost flow, and what we need the business team to confirm · Design reviewed 28 September 2026 · Builds on the POS (till) Sales feature; starts after it is finished

Inventory lets the restaurant know three things at any moment: **what stock is on the shelf, what that stock cost, and what each dish really costs to make**. Deliveries go in. Every sale takes its ingredients out automatically. Waste entries and stock counts fix the difference. On every sale, the cost of the food sold goes into the books (the restaurant's accounts, the figures the accountant works from). The owner gets a true gross profit, sales minus food cost, instead of a guess.

Inventory is an owner tool on the dashboard, the owner's web pages, which are separate from the till. It needs an internet connection. Unlike the till, it does not work while the internet is down.

1. The building blocks, in plain words

Ingredients and units

An ingredient is anything you buy and use: meat, bread, cola. Each one has a **base unit** you count it in (grams, pieces, cans) and the units you **buy** it in (a kilo is 1,000 grams, a bag is 12 pieces, a case is 24 cans).

Recipes

A recipe says what one dish uses: a burger is 1 bun, 150 g of meat, 1 slice of cheese, 30 g of tomato. Extras change the recipe too: "extra cheese" adds one slice, "no tomato" takes 30 g away.

Deliveries (purchases)

A delivery from a supplier: what came in, in which units, and what it cost. Paid now (by bank, or by cash kept outside the till) or on credit, to be paid later. This is what gives every ingredient its cost.

The stock book

Every change of stock is one line in a book that is never edited: a delivery in, a sale out, waste out, a count correction. Stock on hand is simply the total of the book. Mistakes are fixed with a new line, never by changing an old one.

Waste and counts

Waste is stock thrown away, with a reason: spoilage, preparation error, breakage, or other. A stock count is when you count the shelf and the system corrects itself to what you found.

Cost of food sold

Every time a dish is sold, the system takes its ingredients out of stock and writes their cost into the books. Sales minus this cost is your gross profit.

2. How you use it, step by step

1 Set up ingredients and units.

Once, on the dashboard. Meat in grams, bought by the kilo. Buns in pieces, bought by the bag of 12.

2 Write the recipes.

For each menu item and each extra. This is the biggest piece of typing, and it can start the day the feature is ready to use. Until a dish has a recipe, selling it takes nothing out of stock.

3 Record deliveries as they arrive.

Enter the supplier's invoice: 20 kg of meat for \$110, paid by bank or on credit. Stock goes up, the average cost of meat is updated, and the books record the delivery.

4 Sell as usual.

Nothing changes on the till. When a burger is paid, the system automatically takes 1 bun, 150 g of meat, 1 slice of cheese and 30 g of tomato out of stock and writes their cost into the books. A sale is never blocked because stock looks low; the stock simply shows below zero and the owner gets a warning.

5 Record waste when it happens.

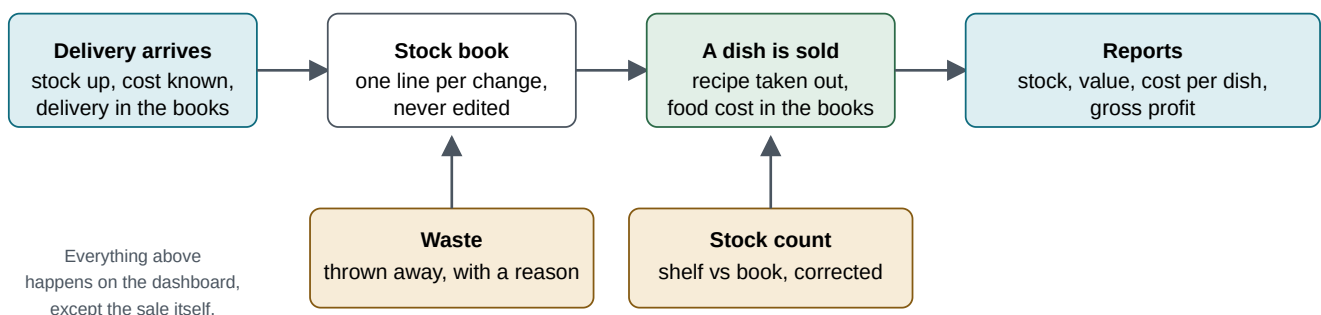
A tray of tomatoes went bad: enter 2 kg, reason "spoilage". Stock goes down and the cost goes to the waste line in the books.

6 Count the shelf after the shift is closed.

Count what is really there. The system compares it with the stock book and writes the difference as a correction, so the book matches the shelf again. The difference is stock that left the shelf without being recorded: waste nobody entered, cooks serving bigger portions than the recipe says, or a recipe that is wrong. You do not have to count everything at once: a count can cover just the ingredients you checked, and only those are corrected.

7 Read the reports.

Current stock and its value, every movement, deliveries, what was used per day, waste, count differences, warnings for stock below zero, the cost of food sold, and the cost and margin of every menu item.



The flow of stock and cost. The stock book is the one record everything else comes from; every screen and report is built from it.

3. How the cost of a dish is worked out

The system uses the **average cost** of each ingredient, updated every time a delivery arrives. This is the method the signed-off project document proposes and the design uses. Example:

Event	Quantity	Money	Average cost of meat
In stock from an earlier delivery	10 kg	\$50.00	\$5.00 per kg
New delivery	10 kg	\$60.00	
After the delivery	20 kg	\$110.00	\$5.50 per kg
One burger sold (150 g of meat)	-0.15 kg	-\$0.82	about \$5.50 per kg (practically unchanged)

So the meat in one burger costs about 82 cents at today's prices. Add the bun, the cheese and the tomato the same way and you have the food cost of a burger. The menu page will show this cost and the margin next to the selling price.

No value gets lost in rounding. The system rounds once per stock movement, and always in a way that keeps the stock value exact: the cost of a sale is the change in stock value, so when the last gram of an ingredient leaves the shelf, the last cent of its value leaves with it. Stock value in the reports is designed to match the Inventory account in the books, and the reports include a check that shows any difference so it can be looked into.

What happens when a delivery is entered late

Example: a delivery of meat arrived on Monday but is entered on Tuesday. Monday's burgers still sell. Each sale is costed at the average price the system already knows for meat (zero, if meat has never been bought before). Stock shows below zero with a warning. On Tuesday, when you enter the delivery, the system re-values the stock at that delivery's price and writes the difference, the gap between the old average and the new price on the food already sold, into Cost of Food Sold as a correction. We propose Cost of Food Sold for this; see question 2 in section 8. Nothing is lost and nothing is blocked; the owner just sees the warning until the delivery is entered.

4. What goes into the accounts (for the accountant)

What happened	What the books record
Delivery paid now, by bank or by cash held outside the till	Inventory (1200) goes up; Bank (1010) or Cash on Hand (1000) goes down
Delivery on credit	Inventory (1200) goes up; Accounts Payable (2000), what you owe the supplier, goes up
Supplier paid later, against one delivery	Accounts Payable (2000) goes down; Bank (1010) or Cash on Hand (1000) goes down
A dish is sold	Inventory (1200) goes down; Cost of Goods Sold (5000) goes up

Waste, or a count finds less than the book	Inventory (1200) goes down; Waste & Inventory Adjustments (5100) goes up
A count finds more than the book	Inventory (1200) goes up; Waste & Inventory Adjustments (5100) goes down
A late delivery re-values stock already sold	The difference goes between Inventory (1200) and Cost of Goods Sold (5000); see question 2
A delivery or a payment is reversed	The opposite of the original entry, at the original cost, linked to it
Opening stock on go-live day, if question 1 is confirmed	Inventory (1200) goes up; Owner's Capital (3000) goes up

"Cash held outside the till" means money the restaurant keeps in the safe or the owner's cash box. Paying a supplier straight from the till drawer is a pay-out (cash taken out of the drawer for an expense). Pay-outs come with a later feature and are not part of this release.

Fixing mistakes

- **Wrong delivery entered** (100 kg instead of 10 kg): the owner **reverses** it with a reason. The system writes the opposite lines in the stock book and in the accounts, at the delivery's original cost, and then the owner enters the correct delivery. The wrong one is never edited or deleted; the history shows both.
- **Wrong delivery already paid**: reverse the payment first, then the delivery.
- **Wrong count**: the next count sets it right; the difference shows in the count report.
- **Once only**: a delivery or a payment can be reversed only once, and a double click cannot reverse it twice; the system refuses the second attempt.

5. Rules worth knowing

- **Sales are never blocked by stock.** The kitchen decides what it can cook; the system reports, it does not stop the till.
- **Count after the shift is closed.** The count page will not save a count while a shift is still open on the till, or while a sale made during an internet outage has not yet reached the server. If it did, that sale would take its ingredients out of stock a second time after the count had already corrected them. The page tells you why it is waiting.
- **Sales made while the internet is down** are costed when they reach the server, at the average cost at that moment. The sale price and tax are frozen at the time of the sale; the ingredient cost is whatever the books know when the sale arrives.
- **Dishes without a recipe cost nothing in the books.** Sales made before a recipe existed will never get a cost added later; the books are permanent. Enter recipes before go-live.
- **A business day** runs from shift open to shift close, so a sale at 1 a.m. counts for the previous evening. Every report uses business days.
- **An ingredient is archived, never deleted**, and cannot be archived while a recipe still uses it.
- **Everything is logged:** who entered, reversed or counted what, and when.

6. What the owner sees

Page	What it shows
Inventory	Every ingredient with stock on hand, its unit, its average cost and its value; a warning on anything below zero; a check that stock value matches the books
Ingredient detail	Its units, and every movement in and out with the reason and which delivery, sale, waste entry or count caused it
Recipes	The recipe of each menu item and each extra, in base units
Deliveries	All deliveries and what is still owed on each one. Here you also record a payment against a delivery (one delivery at a time; there is no supplier account to pay off in one go), or reverse a delivery or a payment
Waste	Enter waste with a reason; the waste history
Stock counts	Enter a count; see every difference and what it was worth
Reports	Ingredients used per business day, waste, count differences, warnings for stock below zero, cost of food sold per business day
Menu	The cost and margin of every dish and extra, next to its price. You cannot change them there

7. What is not in this release

Item	Status	Why
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Supplier records, statements, and reports of how long each supplier bill has been unpaid	later	A delivery carries the supplier's name as text; the "owe the supplier" account exists. Full supplier management is out of the agreed scope.
Recipes inside recipes (sauces made in batches)	later	Out of the agreed scope. A sauce is entered as an ingredient for now.
Paying a supplier from the till drawer	pay-outs feature	That is a till pay-out; it belongs to the pay-outs feature.
Staff meals, free dishes given to guests ("comps"), and waste from dishes cancelled after they were cooked	approvals feature	They use the same stock book; the screens and owner approvals come with that feature.
More than one storage location (cold store, dry store)	not planned	One stock figure per ingredient in this release.
Purchase orders, receiving workflows, barcodes, expiry dates, reorder alerts	not planned	Not part of this first release.
Anything on the till	no change	The till never sees recipes or costs. Inventory is an owner tool on the dashboard and needs an internet connection.

8. Decisions we need from the business team

The design uses the defaults below. Please confirm or change them before the build starts. Question 1 comes first: it decides how you go live.

#	Question	Default
1	Stock already on the shelf on go-live day: how do we enter it? It was not bought through the system.	An "opening stock" entry with a quantity and a cost per unit, recorded as money the owner put into the business. Until this is decided, a stock count will refuse to add stock to an ingredient that has never had a delivery, so opening stock cannot be entered by simply counting the shelf. Please answer this question first.
2	When a late delivery is entered at a price different from the average used for food already sold, where does the difference go?	To Cost of Goods Sold (5000), because it is the true cost of food that was sold. The alternative is Waste & Inventory Adjustments (5100), which would keep it out of the food-cost figure.
3	May deliveries be paid in cash on the dashboard?	Yes, meaning cash kept outside the till. Drawer cash is a pay-out.
4	When can a stock count be saved?	Only when no shift is open and no sale is still on its way to the server.
5	Can the owner reverse a delivery and a supplier payment?	Yes, with a reason; the history keeps both.
6	How precise is the average cost?	To a millionth of a cent per gram (or piece, or can), so a cost per gram or per millilitre does not lose precision when it is stored.
7	Units: a fixed list, or free text per ingredient?	Free text: g, ml, pcs, can, whatever you use.
8	Where are recipes edited?	Under Inventory. The Menu page shows cost and margin but you cannot change them there.
9	What date does a reversal get?	The day it is made, in the restaurant's time zone, not the date of the original delivery. So reversing last month's delivery shows up in this month's figures, and last month's reports stay as they were.
10	Can an ingredient be archived while a recipe uses it?	No. Fix the recipe first.
11	Can "no tomato" on a dish with no tomato add tomato to stock?	No. An extra can never push usage below zero.
12	Sales made while the internet is down: costed at the time of sale, or when they reach the server?	When they reach the server. The till never carries costs.

13	For speed, the system keeps a ready-made stock-on-hand total for each ingredient next to the stock book. Should there be a button to recalculate that total from the stock book if the two ever disagree?	No. The Inventory page shows any difference, and we would decide the fix if it ever happens.
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9. Timing

This feature builds on the till's Sales feature and starts after it is finished. The build is split into seven stages. The parts you can see, the screens and reports, come in the last stage, so they will be the last thing ready. Typing in the recipes will take the longest, so it should start the day the feature is ready to use.

What we need from the business team now: (1) answers to the 13 questions above; (2) a first list of ingredients with the units you buy them in; (3) a recipe for each menu item and each extra. Then the data is ready when the screens are.